

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 3

♥ 9 4

♦ K J 10

♣ K 8 7 2

♠ 7 2

♥ A K 10 7 3

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 5 4



♠ A Q 9 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 7 5

♣ Q J 10 6

♠ K J 6

♥ Q J 8 6 2

♦ 6 4 2

♣ 9 3

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

holds the ♠A then leading up to the ♠K would eliminate one of the ♠ losers - that would at least get you to down only 1.

Or, if East holds the ♠Q and West the ♠A then leading up to the ♠J would also eliminate one ♠ loser. But this play has another advantage - if East should happen to hold **BOTH** the ♠A and ♠Q then leading up to the ♠J will actually let you make the contract. So you win the ♣A, pull two trumps, then play a ♠ to the ♠J. If that wins, back to your hand with a trump and play your other ♠ to the ♠K.

Some times you don't really expect to make a contract - this is one of those times.

But you should still ask yourself if there is some distribution that will allow you to be successful. And if there is, just assume that distribution and boldly play the cards out.

You open 1♥ and partner jumps to 4♥. You pass.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♣Q.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♣ losers are shown as 1 since you will always be able to ruff a ♣ in dummy.

South's precipitous leap to 4♥ was made partly in hopes of making the contract, and partly as a preemptive bid to shut the opponents up. So it wouldn't be a surprise to land in an unmakeable contract. However, this one has a slim chance. The only suit you might make something of is ♠s. If East

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ J 10 9

♦ 9 4

♣ Q 8 6 5

♠ K 8 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ J 6 5 3

♣ A 7 2



♠ A 6 4

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K J 10 3

♠ 9 2

♥ A Q 8 4 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ 9 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♣Q so naturally you will finesse West. You dare not let West get into the lead since he can lead through dummy's ♥K. If East gets the lead with the ♣Q, he cannot hurt you.

Win the first trick with the ♠A. (**DO NOT HOLD UP, WEST MAY SWITCH**). Play the ♣K then ♣J, letting it ride if not covered. East can win the ♣Q but cannot lead a ♥ without giving you a trick. You win whatever else he returns and make your 9 tricks. Of course you must be careful to unblock the ♦ A K Q while you still have a dummy entry to the ♦J.

This is another hand where you want to keep a particular defender off lead. In this hand it is West who is the Danger hand.

Be on the lookout for this type of situation because many times you have a finesse that can be made either way. So you finesse into the Safe hand.

Balanced, 17 points. You open 1NT. Partner's response is 2♣.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman. You have no 4-card Major to show so you bid 2♦. Partner now says 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠Q.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

The only thing better than being good is being lucky! You are very lucky that you didn't get a ♥ lead - now you must take advantage of your good luck.

You only need one more winner, and the ♣ suit is your best bet. You can finesse either defender for the

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ -
 ♥ K 6 3
 ♦ K J 10 9 4 2
 ♣ 10 9 6 2

♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q J 10 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 5
 ♣ K J 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 10 7 4 3
 ♥ 5
 ♦ Q 3
 ♣ Q 7 5

♠ A 9 6 2
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ A 8 7 6
 ♣ A 4 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	3♥	3♠	4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. East overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and West ruffs. What if West also gets a trick with the ♥K and East gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.

East probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A West will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let East win the trick while West shows out as expected. East will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So East will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, West winning the ♥K. West will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until West no longer had a trump.